ONI DOJO 鬼道場

N4

JLPT N4 Workbook

Everyday Japanese

Plain forms, te-form patterns, giving and receiving, conditionals and the casual speech you hear around you.

30	88	363	10	819
LESSONS	GRAMMAR POINTS	WORDS	READINGS	EXERCISES

with Kurenai 紅 · Slettvold Security · slettvold.org

How to use this workbook

> *“Welcome to my dojo. I am Kurenai, your sensei, and yes, I am an oni. Don't worry, I only bite lazy students. Work through one lesson at a time, write your answers by hand, and check them at the back. Then do it again in a week. That's the whole secret.”*

1. **Read the grammar.** Each point has a short explanation and examples. Read the examples aloud.
2. **Learn the words.** Tick the box when you know a word without looking.
3. **Read the dialogue** and cover the English to see how much you understand.
4. **Do the practice** on paper without looking back, then check your answers in the answer key.
5. **Read the stories** placed between the lessons. They only use what you have learned so far.
6. **Review.** Come back to a lesson after a few days and a week. Spaced review is what makes words stick.

Furigana (small kana above kanji) is shown in grammar, dialogues and stories. Try reading without it first. In the practice sections there is less help, as in the real test.

This workbook follows the N4 course in the **Oni Dojo** app (slettvold.org/onidojo), where every sentence also has audio, flashcards and typed answers. You can use the book on its own or together with the app.

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· Answer key

· Word list

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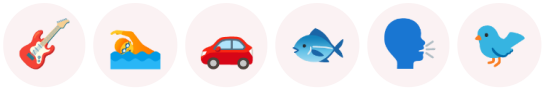
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N4 · LESSON 1

Can do: the potential form

可能形(かのうけい)



In this lesson you will

- Make the potential form of any verb
- Say what you can and can't do
- Use が with potential verbs

Grammar

1 Potential form *can do …*

Group 2 (る-verbs): drop る, add られる — 食(た)べる → 食(た)べられる, 見(み)る → 見(み)られる. In casual speech many people drop ら: 見(み)れる, 食(た)べれる (common, but avoid it in writing).

Group 1 (う-verbs): change the last sound to the え-row and add る — 書(か)く → 書(か)ける, 話(はな)す → 話(はな)せる, 読(よ)む → 読(よ)める, 買(か)う → 買(か)える.

Irregular: する → できる, 来(く)る → 来(きた)られる (こられる).

The result is itself a group 2 verb: 話(はな)せます, 話(はな)せない, 話(はな)せた.

漢字(かんじ)が少(すこ)し読(よ)めます。	I can read a little kanji.
日本語(にほんご)で電話(でんわ)がかけられますか。	Can you make a phone call in Japanese?
昨日(きのう)はよく寝(ね)られなかった。	I couldn't sleep well last night.
明日(あした)は来(こ)られますか。	Can you come tomorrow?

2 ～が＋potential *the object takes が*

With potential verbs the thing you can do is usually marked by が instead of を: 日本語(にほんご)が話(はな)せます. Using を is also heard, especially with long sentences, but が is the textbook choice.

わたしは刺身(さしみ)が食(た)べられません。	I can't eat sashimi.
ここから富士山(ふじさん)が見(み)えます。	You can see Mt Fuji from here.
ピアノが弾(はじ)けるようになりたいです。	I want to become able to play the piano.

3 見(み)える・聞(き)こえる *can be seen / can be heard*

見(み)える and 聞(き)こえる mean things are visible or audible on their own — no effort. 見(み)られる and 聞(き)ける mean you are able to (because you have the chance): 映画(えいが)が見(み)られる "I can watch the film (it's showing)".

窓(まど)から海(うみ)が見(み)えます。	You can see the sea from the window.
鳥(とり)の声(こえ)が聞(き)こえる。	I can hear birds.
この部屋(へや)ではラジオが聞(き)けます。	You can listen to the radio in this room.

Vocabulary

	WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
	できる		can do; be done	☐
🎸	弾く	ひく	play (an instrument)	☐
🏊	泳ぐ	およぐ	swim	☐
🚗	運転	うんてん	driving	☐
	見える	みえる	be visible	☐
	聞こえる	きこえる	be audible	☐
🐟	刺身	さしみ	sashimi	☐
🗣️	声	こえ	voice	☐
🐦	鳥	とり	bird	☐
📞	電話をかける	でんわをかける	make a phone call	☐
	乗れる	のれる	can ride	☐

Dialogue: What can you do?

Kurenai interviews you for a job at the dojo.

紅 日本語(にほんご)で何(なに)ができる？

What can you do in Japanese?

あなた ひらがなとカタカナが読(よ)めます。漢字(かんじ)は少(すこ)し読(よ)めます。

I can read hiragana and katakana. I can read a little kanji.

紅 日本語(にほんご)で電話(でんわ)はかけられる？

Can you make phone calls in Japanese?

あなた まだかけられません。でも、ゆっくり話(はな)せば、わかります。

Not yet. But if people speak slowly, I understand.

紅 わたしは空(そら)が飛(と)べるよ。

I can fly.

あなた えっ、本当(ほんとう)ですか。

What, really?

紅 うそ。でも、火(ひ)は出(だ)せる。

Kidding. But I can breathe fire.

Kurenai's culture corner

Many Japanese learners set the JLPT as their goal, but employers in Japan often care more about what you can actually do: answer the phone (電話対応(でんわたいおう)), write a polite email, read a contract. The Japan Foundation's own JF Standard describes each level with "can-do" statements, just like the goals of this lesson.

Practice

1.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 見える
2. _____ 鳥
3. _____ 通訳
4. _____ 弾く
5. _____ 運転
6. _____ 乗れる
7. _____ 電話をかける
8. _____ できる
9. _____ 刺身
10. _____ 将来

a can do; be done

b sashimi 🐟

c play (an instrument) 🎸

d future

e be visible

f driving 🚗

g interpreter 🗣️

h bird 🐦

i can ride

j make a phone call 📞

1.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 漢字(かんじ)が少(すこ)し読____ます。 (I can read a little kanji.)

   a も **b** ま **c** め **d** む

2. 刺身(さしみ)が食(た)べ____ません。 (I can't eat sashimi.)

   a れれ **b** え **c** られ **d** させ

3. 日本語(にほんご)が話(はなし)____ますか。 (Can you speak Japanese?)

   a そ **b** せ **c** さ **d** す

4. 明日(あした)は来(き)____ますか。 (Can you come tomorrow?)

   a け **b** れ **c** させ **d** られ

5. 窓(まど)から海(うみ)が____ます。 (You can see the sea from the window.)

   a 見られ **b** 見せ **c** 見え **d** 見

6. ピアノ____弾(ひ)けます。 (I can play the piano.)

   a で **b** が **c** に **d** へ

1.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. I can read a little kanji.

2. Can you swim?

3. I couldn't sleep last night.

4. You can see Mt Fuji from here.

1.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ 日本語(にほんご)で何(なに)ができる？
2. _____ ひらがなとカタカナが読(よ)めます。漢字(かんじ)は少(すこ)し読(よ)めます。
3. _____ 日本語(にほんご)で電話(でんわ)はかけられる？
4. _____ まだかけられません。でも、ゆっくり話(はな)せば、わかります。
5. _____ わたしは空(そら)が飛(と)べるよ。
6. _____ えっ、本当(ほんとう)ですか。
7. _____ うそ。でも、火(ひ)は出(だ)せる。

a I can fly.

b Not yet. But if people speak slowly, I understand.

c I can read hiragana and katakana. I can read a little kanji.

d Kidding. But I can breathe fire.

e What can you do in Japanese?

f Can you make phone calls in Japanese?

g What, really?

N4 · LESSON 2

Intentions and plans 意向形・つもり・予定

In this lesson you will

- Make the volitional form (let's …)
- Say what you intend to do with ～ようと思う and つもり
- Talk about schedules with 予定

Grammar

1 Volitional form *let's … (casual)*

The casual version of ましょう. Group 2: る → よう (食べよう). Group 1: last sound → お-row + う (行く → 行こう, 飲む → 飲もう, 帰る → 帰ろう). Irregular: する → しよう, 来る → 来よう (こよう).

一緒に帰ろう。	Let's go home together.
もう寝よう。	Let's go to bed now.
ちょっと休もうか。	Shall we take a little break?

2 ～ようと思っています *I'm thinking of …, I intend to …*

Volitional + と思う states an intention you've just decided; と思っている suggests you've been planning it for a while.

来年、日本へ留学しようと思っています。	I'm planning to study in Japan next year.
今晩はカレーを作ろうと思う。	I think I'll make curry tonight.
仕事をやめようと思ったことがあります。	I have thought about quitting my job.

3 ～つもりです／～予定です *intend to … / be scheduled to …*

Dictionary form + つもり is a firm personal intention. Negative: 行かないつもりです "I don't intend to go". 予定 is a schedule or plan that's been fixed, often with other people: 会議は三時の予定です.

夏休みに北海道へ行くつもりです。	I intend to go to Hokkaido in the summer holidays.
今日はお酒を飲まないつもりです。	I don't intend to drink today.
新幹線は十時に着く予定です。	The bullet train is scheduled to arrive at ten.

Vocabulary

	WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
🎓	**留学**	りゅうがく	study abroad	☐
📅	**予定**	よてい	plan, schedule	☐
	つもり		intention	☐
	計画	けいかく	plan	☐
	決める	きめる	decide	☐
	やめる		quit, stop	☐
	着く	つく	arrive	☐
👥	**会議**	かいぎ	meeting	☐
📦	**引っ越す**	ひっこす	move house	☐
	貯金	ちょきん	savings	☐
💒	**結婚**	けっこん	marriage	☐
	北海道	ほっかいどう	Hokkaido	☐
	今晩	こんばん	tonight	☐

Dialogue: New year's plans

On New Year's Day you share resolutions.

紅 今年(ことし)の目標(もくひょう)は？

What's your goal this year?

あなた N4を受(う)けようと思(おも)っています。

I'm planning to take the N4.

紅 いいね。毎日(まいにち)どのくらい勉強(べんきょう)するつもり？

Nice. How much do you intend to study each day?

あなた 一時間(いちじかん)ぐらいのつもりです。秋(あき)には日本(にほん)へ行(い)く予定(よてい)です。

About an hour. And I'm scheduled to go to Japan in the autumn.

紅 じゃあ、わたしも行(い)こうかな。

Then maybe I'll go too.

あなた 先生(せんせい)、パスポートはありますか。

Sensei, do you have a passport?

紅 ……鬼(おに)は飛(と)んで行(い)くの。

…Oni fly there.

Kurenai's culture corner

At New Year (お正月) many people write a 書き初め — the first calligraphy of the year — often a word expressing their goal for the year, such as 努力 (effort) or 合格 (passing). They also buy a daruma doll, paint in one eye when making a wish, and the other when it comes true.

Practice

2.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 決める
2. _____ 予定
3. _____ 着く
4. _____ 夢
5. _____ やめる
6. _____ 会議
7. _____ 留学
8. _____ 今晩
9. _____ 計画
10. _____ 北海道

a dream 💭
b tonight
c quit, stop
d meeting 👥
e arrive
f decide
g study abroad 🎓
h plan
i plan, schedule 📅
j Hokkaido

2.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 一緒(いっしょ)に帰(かえ)____。 (Let's go home together.)

   a るよう **b** ろう **c** ろ **d** りよう

2. もう寝(ね)____。 (Let's go to bed.)

   a おう **b** ろう **c** こう **d** よう

3. 日本(にほん)へ留学(りゅうがく)し____と思(おも)っています。 (I'm planning to study in Japan.)

   a よう **b** て **c** に **d** ろう

4. 夏休(なつやす)みに北海道(ほっかいどう)へ行(い)く____です。 (I intend to go to Hokkaido.)

   a ながら **b** たい **c** つもり **d** ましょう

5. 新幹線(しんかんせん)は十時(じゅうじ)に着(つ)く____です。 (The train is scheduled to arrive at ten.)

   a 予定 **b** たい **c** つもり **d** ながら

6. 今日(きょう)はお酒(さけ)を飲(の)ま____つもりです。 (I don't intend to drink today.)

   a ないで **b** ず **c** ない **d** なく

2.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. Let's rest a little.

2. I'm planning to study in Japan next year.

3. I intend to go to Hokkaido.

4. The meeting is scheduled for three.

2.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ 今年(ことし)の目標(もくひょう)は？
2. _____ N4を受(う)けようと思(おも)っています。
3. _____ いいね。毎日(まいにち)どのくらい勉強(べんきょう)するつもり？
4. _____ 一時間(いちじかん)ぐらいのつもりです。秋(あき)には日本(にほん)へ行(い)く予定(よてい)です。
5. _____ じゃあ、わたしも行(い)こうかな。
6. _____ 先生(せんせい)、パスポートはありますか。
7. _____ ……鬼(おに)は飛(と)んで行(い)くの。

a I'm planning to take the N4.

b …Oni fly there.

c What's your goal this year?

d Sensei, do you have a passport?

e Then maybe I'll go too.

f Nice. How much do you intend to study each day?

g About an hour. And I'm scheduled to go to Japan in the autumn.

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続く…

That was lessons 1 and 2 of 30 lessons.

“Not bad, pupil. The full JLPT N4 workbook has every lesson, every reading, the complete answer key and the word list. Come and get it, I'll be waiting.” — Kurenai

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